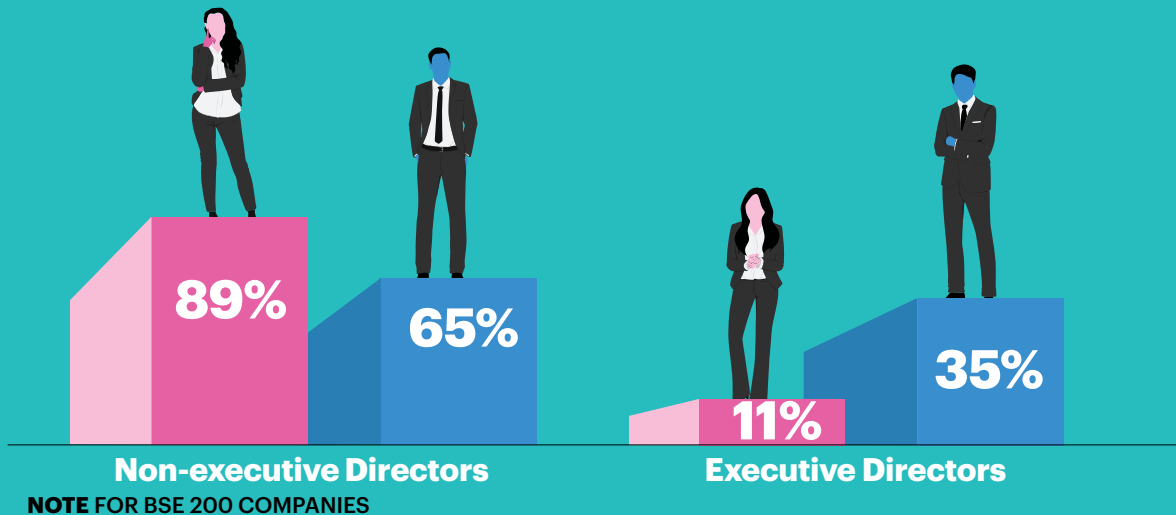
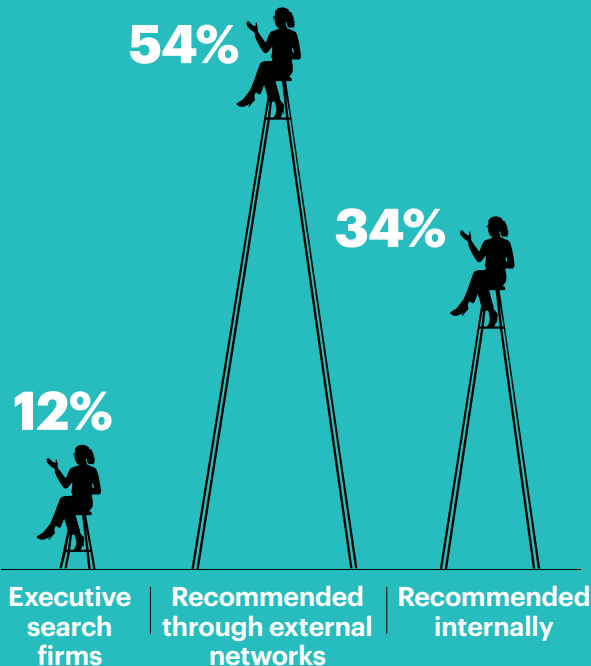


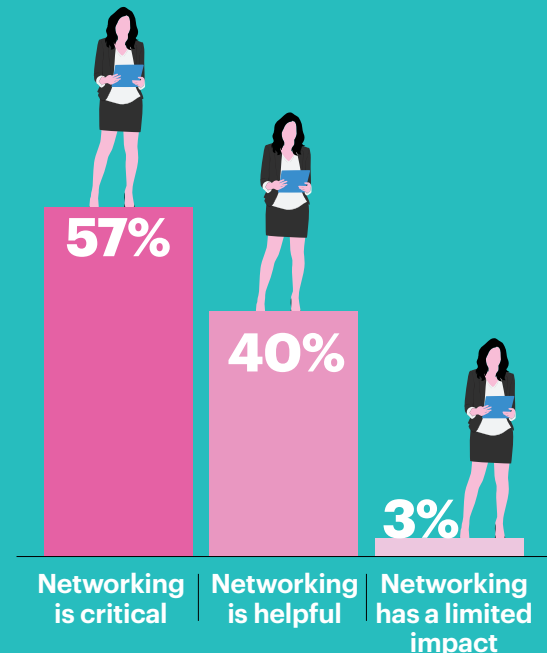
Stark Divide



First board appointment for women



Connections matter for women to reach the top



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ILLUSTRATION BY **RAJ VERMA**

mended her to the chairman of a multinational company, “resulting in pivotal career advancement.”

Manisha Girotra, CEO of investment bank Moelis India, says, “We have come a long way with many well-qualified women from professional backgrounds sitting on boards.” The mandate of having at least one woman per board is the hitch. “Only a few are trying to increase that to two,” she explains, before naming Marico and

Sona Comstar as exceptions.

To her mind, women bring great improvements on parameters such as return on capital, return to shareholders, sustainability, succession planning, retention of talent and leadership. “In this world of high destruction created by artificial intelligence (AI), the skills that women bring to the table, especially those relating to high EQ (emotional quotient), will attract talent. Tal-